

CacaoSoundCues Pro Manual

Script-linked sound cue playback for the stage

Version 5.1.7 / October 2026

What this manual covers

1. What Pro adds (differences from the Simple version)
2. Importing and displaying a script
3. Linking cues to the script (the cue band)
4. Following the script, playing from the band, and **Script Run** (play cues in script order with Enter)
5. Outputs (sending sounds to several speakers or devices)
6. Running with a backup Mac
7. MIDI control (controllers and lighting consoles)
8. What is saved, and troubleshooting

> For the basics (assigning sounds, fades, lists, Show Mode), see the **CacaoSoundCues Manual** (Simple version). Pro works the same way.

What Pro adds

Script link

- Shows a ScenarioWriterSolo script (.scwd) or an ordinary **PDF** script beside the main window
- Links keys and list tracks to **positions in the script text**
- A **cue band** under each page, like a sound operator's marked-up script
- **Script Run**: Standby moves through the script in order — Enter plays, Space stops

Outputs

- Choose the speaker (device and channels) for each key or track

Running with a backup Mac

- Operations on the main Mac are sent to a second Mac, which plays the same way
- If the main Mac stops, carry on with the backup

MIDI control

- Operate from MIDI controllers, foot pedals or a lighting console (MSC), and send MIDI to the console when sounds start

Compatibility with the Simple version

- Cue sheets (.ccsc) are the same format. A cue sheet made in Pro opens safely in the Simple version (script links and other Pro data are simply ignored)

1. Installing and launching

1. Double-click **CacaoSoundCuesPro-5.1.7.dmg** to open it
2. Drag **CacaoSoundCuesPro** onto **Applications**
3. Double-click CacaoSoundCuesPro in the Applications folder to launch

It can sit next to the Simple version (CacaoSoundCues).

Settings are kept separately.

If macOS says the developer cannot be verified

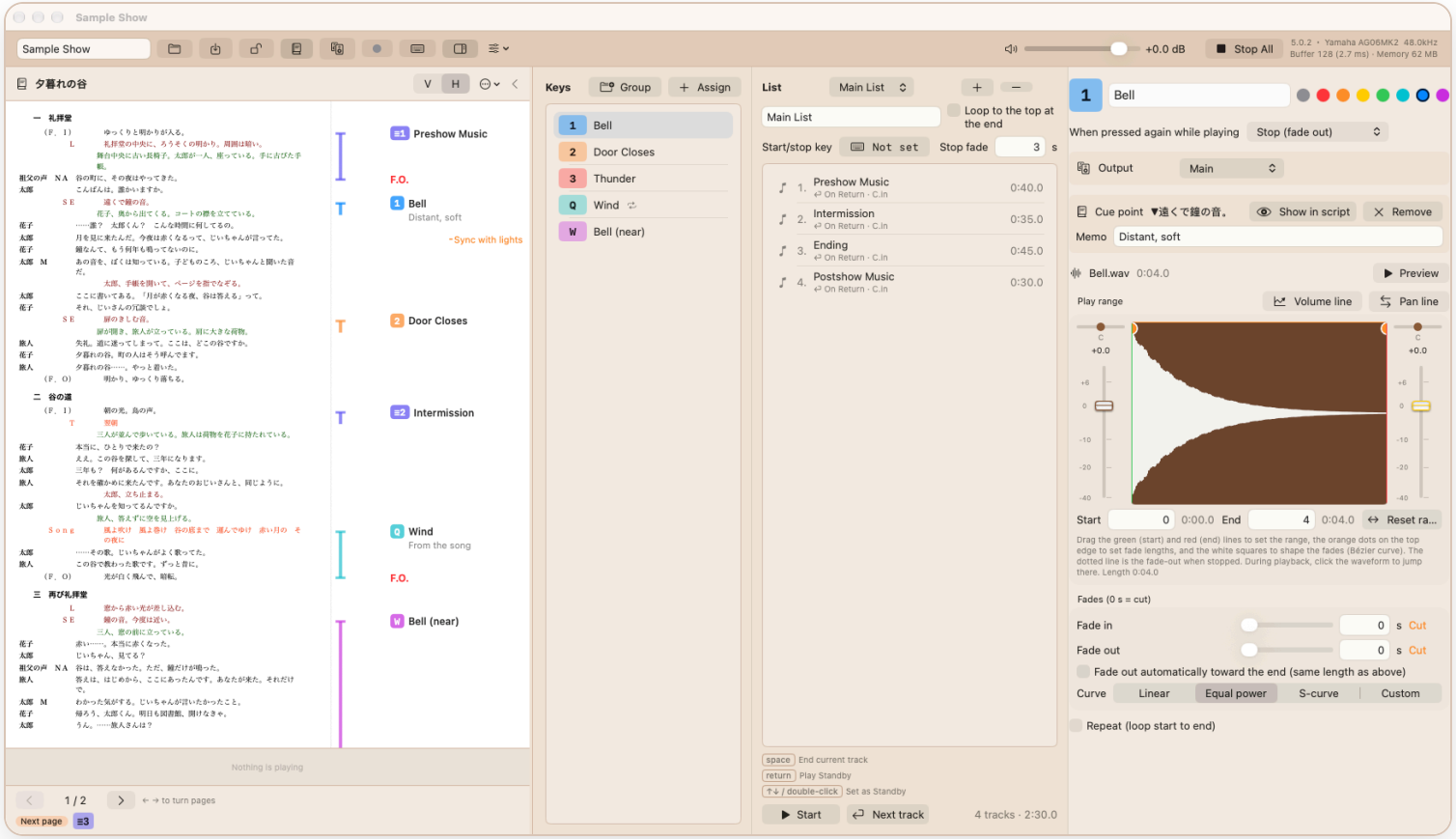
macOS 15 or later: close the alert, then click **Open Anyway** in **System Settings › Privacy & Security**.

macOS 14: **right-click the app → Open → Open**.

If asked to allow finding devices on your local network

This is used to connect to the backup Mac on the same network. Click **Allow**.

2. The main window



Left: script panel (cue band below, then the waveform of what is playing and page turning) / Middle: key list and list / Right: settings of the selected sound (the “Output” and “Cue point” rows are Pro features)

3. Top bar buttons

Button	What it does
Script	Show or hide the script panel
Output	Set up outputs (devices and channels) → section 9
MIDI	MIDI control (input device, output device, assignments) → section 11
Backup	Running with a backup Mac → section 10. Dot color: gray = off, green = connected, orange = cue sheets differ, red = disconnected
Keyboard	Show or hide the keyboard (hidden: a list of assigned keys)
List	Show or hide the list area (hidden when there are no lists; click to get “Create List”)
Inspector	Show or hide the settings on the right. Hiding it gives the script more room

When the window is narrow (or the labels are long, as in English), the buttons show icons only. Hover to see the name.

4. Importing a script

1. In the script panel, click ··· → **Import Script…**
2. Choose a ScenarioWriterSolo script (**.scwd**) or a **PDF** (see “PDF scripts” two pages on)
3. The script is copied into the cue sheet

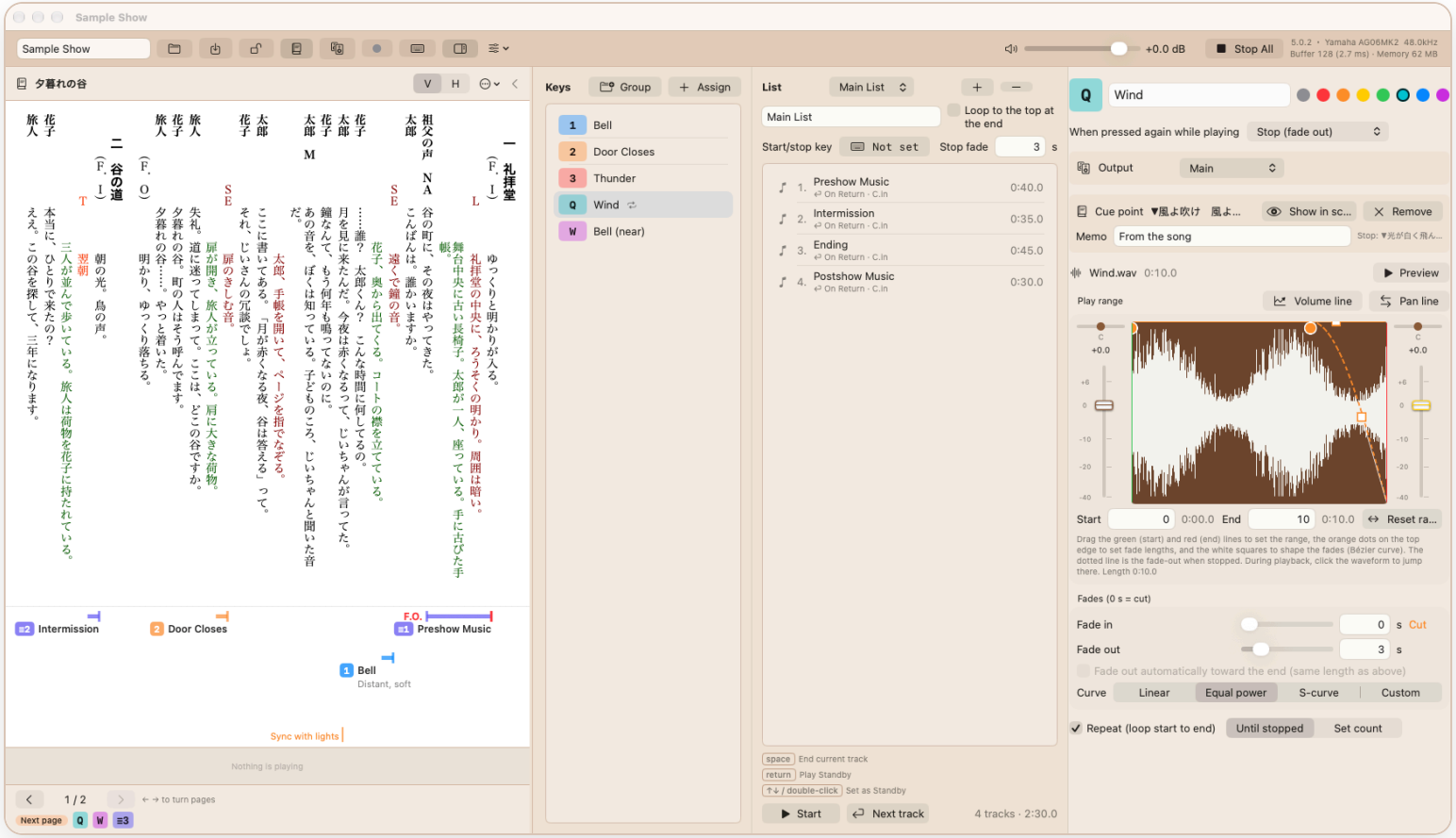
- After editing the script, use **Reload Script**
- Lines are found by an ID that ScenarioWriterSolo gives each line, so links stay put when the script is edited

Display (··· menu)

- **V / H**: vertical or horizontal writing
- **Text Size** (upper limit), **Line Spacing**, **Letter Spacing**
- **Character Name Width**, **Characters per Line**: normally as set in the script; can be changed for this cue sheet only

Lines wrap by the script’s format (name column + characters per line), so they break where they do on paper. If a line does not fit, the text gets smaller. Display settings are saved in the cue sheet.

Vertical and horizontal



Vertical: the cue band is under the page (lines run right to left). Horizontal: it is on the right.

PDF scripts (other than ScenarioWriterSolo)

- **Import Script…** also accepts a **PDF** (each page shown as it is)
- **Text size and spacing cannot be changed**
- **V / H** is the script's direction (V: band below, ← is next / H: band on the right)
- Page turning and the cue band work as with a .scwd script
- A **colored line** is also drawn on the page at each cue

Choose V / H before linking (changing it later moves the lines).

Password-protected PDFs cannot be read.



5. Turning and scrolling pages

Turning pages

- ← → or ‹ › at the bottom
- In vertical writing, as in a Japanese book, ← is the next page

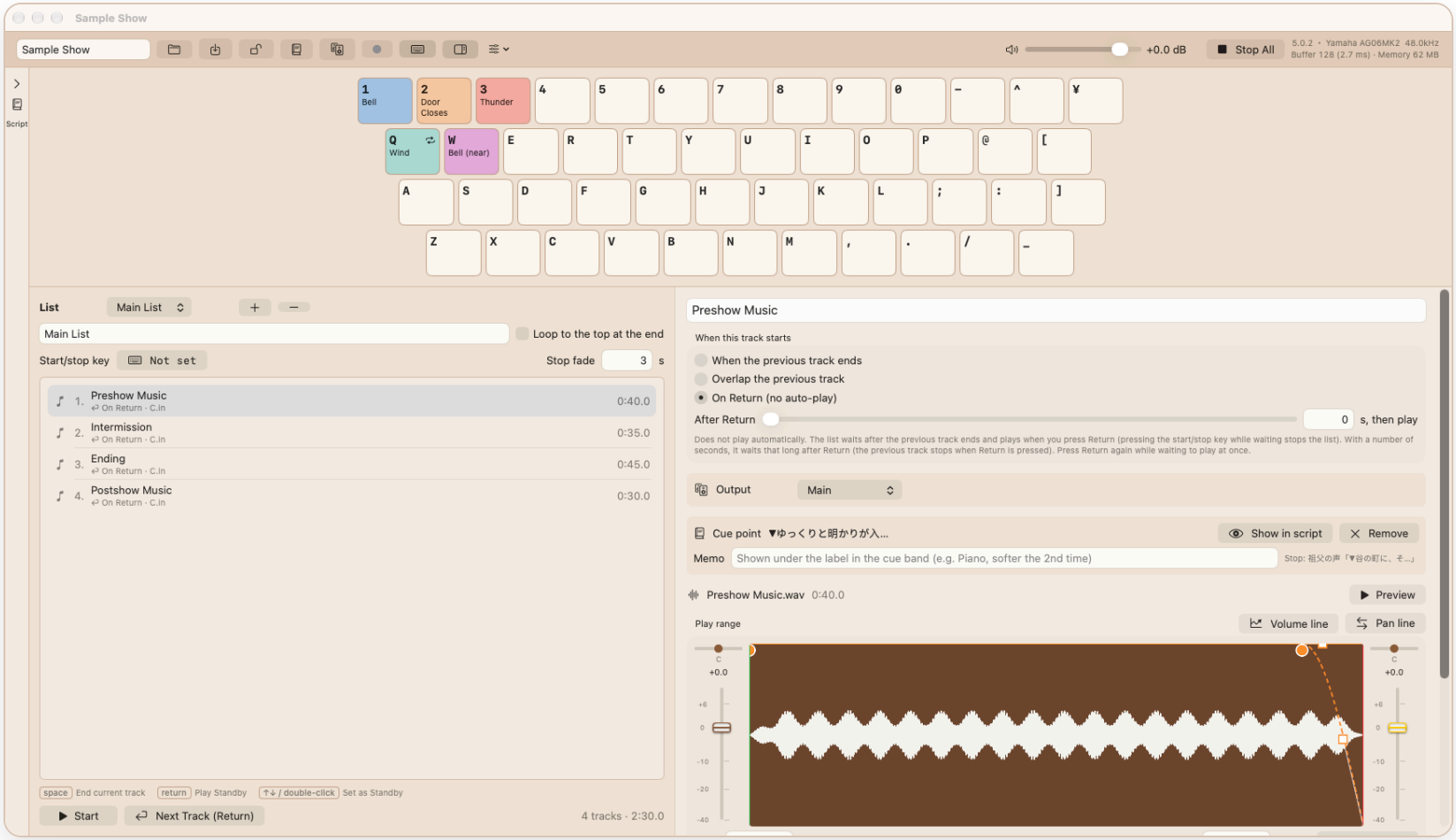
Scrolling

- Mouse wheel, **horizontal scroll** (side wheel) or trackpad scroll the pages like a scroll of paper
- They stop where you stop (you can view across two pages)

Panel width

- Drag the divider between the script and the main window
- While the script is shown, the main window is laid out side by side: **keyboard | sound settings** (the list, when there is one, goes under the keyboard; the settings only when shown)
- Drag to the right edge to **fill the window** with the script (the main window is hidden; keys and Return still work). Click ‹ at the right edge, or drag it a little to the left, to bring the main window back
- Click ‹ in the panel header to **fold** the script to the left (click the thin strip to open it)

Folding the script



When folded, the main window takes the script's space. Click the thin strip on the left to open the script again.

6. Linking cues

In the band (recommended)

1. Select a key or list track
2. **Right-click** the **cue band** under the page at that point
3. Choose **Cue “…” Here**

The line starts exactly where you clicked (even between lines).

In the text

- You can also right-click the script text to link
- The **Cue point** row in the inspector shows or removes the link

Stop point (end of the line)

- Right-click the band → **Stop Here**
- The line is drawn to that point and marked **F.O.** (fade out) or **C.O.**
- Lines that cross a page continue on the next page

Adjusting a line

- **Drag** the vertical mark at the start or end of a line
- **Double-click** a mark to put it back on the text

Reading the cue band

- Badge: **the key to press** (in the key's color) or a list track (≡ and number)
- A **memo** under the name (e.g. "Distant, soft"). Write it in the inspector's Memo or by right-clicking the band
- Line: from the cue to the stop point. It gets thicker while playing
- Orange text: a **note** not tied to a cue (e.g. "Sync with lights")

> Just like pencilling A, S and so on into a paper script, you can see directly what to press.

Right-clicking the band

Where you right-click	What you can do
Empty space	**Cue the selected key or track here** (if already linked: **Also cue here** / Move here) / **Stop here** / **Write a note here…**
Badge or line	**Play** / **Stop** (while playing) / Write memo / Stop here Reset line position / Remove stop point / **Unlink** (remove from the script)
A note	Edit memo / Delete memo

In Show Mode, only Play and Stop are available.

Using the same sound in several places

Same settings → add more cue points

- Select the key or track, right-click another spot in the band → “**Also cue … here**”
- Or use “**Also add at selection**” in the inspector’s Cue point row (it then shows “n more”)
- Each place gets its own line in the band, with its own stop point and memo
- In Script Run, each one is a separate Standby. Playing shows on the line you played

For a key or track that is already linked, “Move here” (shown when it has only one cue point) moves the existing cue point.

Different volume → copy the key

- On the keyboard, hold `option` and drag the key onto an **empty key**
- You get **another key** with the same sound, volume, fades and output
- Change the copy’s volume and link it to another place in the script

Cue points and “Send MIDI” settings are not copied (so a lighting console doesn’t get two messages). If the target key is already assigned, nothing is overwritten and you are told.

7. Using the script during a show

Playing and stopping from the band

- ⌘-click or control-click a badge or line to **play** it
- Right-click → **Stop (fade out)** stops just that sound (not Esc's Stop All)

Turning pages automatically

- ⋯ → **Turn pages to the Standby cue automatically** (off by default; you turn the pages yourself)
- In Script Run, the page turns **after the cue you just played finishes** (see the next section)

Waveform of what is playing

- Under the script, the waveforms of the sounds playing are shown (up to 3)
- The newest sound looks like the sound settings: the **fade shape** (orange), **volume line** (light blue), **pan line** (pink), the yellow playhead and the fade in progress. On the right, **the current pan and volume** (sound volume × fade × lines); on the left, the badge and **time remaining**
- The others are thin waveforms only (played part darker, the yellow line is the current volume)

In Show Mode, links and notes cannot be changed (playing and stopping still work).

Script Run (play cues in script order with Enter)

Click **Script Run** in the script panel header to play cues **in script order** (the order of the cue lines).

- The first cue in the script goes on **Standby**
- return (Enter): play the Standby cue and move Standby to the next cue
- space: stop one playing sound (with its own fade-out setting)
- ↑ ↓: move Standby to the previous / next cue
- esc (Stop All): stop everything and end Script Run

What you see during Script Run

- While it is on, the button reads **End Run**. Click it to clear Standby from the script and go back to normal
- Tags under the cue name on each cue line: **Standby** (orange), **Playing** (green), **Fading** (gray, being stopped)
- The sound that Space will stop next has a space mark after Playing
- The bottom bar (page row) shows Standby and “space ▸ the track that will stop”
- List tracks linked to the script show Standby / Playing in the list too

Script Run rules

Which sound Space stops

- **Follows the cue lines**: among sounds with a stop position (F.O./C.O.), the one that **ends first in the script**
- If none of those are playing, the sound started most recently
- When in doubt, the sound with the space mark is the one that stops

Changing Standby

- ↑ ↓, **double-click** a label in the band, or right-click → “Put on Standby”
- ⌘-click a tag in the band to play it; Standby moves to the cue after it (continue from there)

Lists become “places to keep tracks”

- During Script Run, lists **don’t play continuously**. Tracks play one at a time, with Enter
- List start/stop keys and the Start button don’t work
- Playing sounds by pressing their keys (the key map) works as usual

Script Run on/off is saved on this Mac (like Show Mode, it stays on after relaunching). When running with a backup Mac, the main Mac’s actions reach the backup too. Pressing Esc by hand on the backup only stops the sound.

8. What the cue sheet stores

Pro data is stored inside the cue sheet (.ccsc).

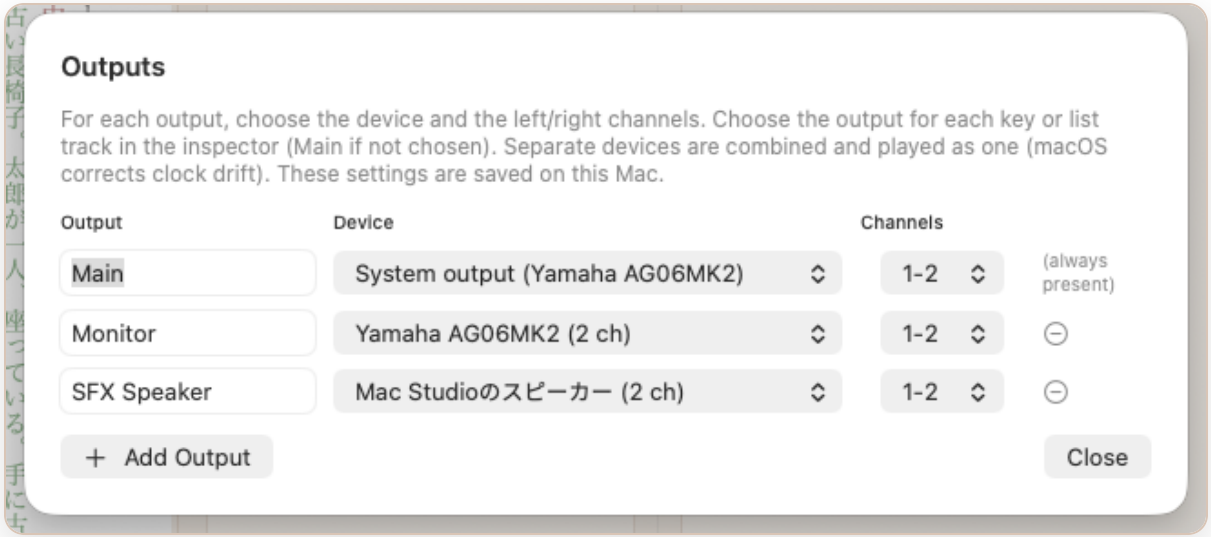
- **pro.json**: links, stop points, line positions, memos, notes, display settings, the output for each key or track, and MIDI assignments
- **Script/**: a copy of the imported script (.scwd or PDF)

- The Simple version leaves these alone, so **opening and saving in the Simple version does not remove them**
- Take the cue sheet to another Mac and the script goes with it

Output device settings, the backup role, and the MIDI input and output devices are saved per Mac (not in the cue sheet).

9. Outputs (multiple outputs)

1. Click **Output** in the top bar
2. For each output, set a **name**, **device** and **channels** (1-2, 3-4 …). The first one is **Main**
3. **Add Output** to add more
4. Select a key or list track and choose its output under **Output** in the inspector (Main if not chosen)



If you choose **separate devices**, they are combined and played as one (macOS corrects clock drift; the sample rate follows the main device). Tracks in a list follow each other seamlessly even on different outputs.

Notes on outputs

- **Device settings are saved on this Mac.** Keys and tracks store the **output name**, so on another Mac, create outputs with the same names and they play the same way (an unknown name plays on Main)
- If a chosen device cannot be used (not connected, unavailable), sounds play on the **system output** and the Outputs window tells you
- Outputs are reapplied automatically when devices are plugged in or out
- Changing outputs stops what is playing. Set them up **before the show**
- With only Main on “system output, 1-2”, playback is the same as the Simple version

10. Running with a backup Mac

How it works

- **Operations** on the main Mac (play, stop, Standby, list start/stop, Esc, master volume, script pages and scrolling) are sent to the backup Mac as they happen
- **Audio is not sent.** Each Mac plays from its own device
- Connect the two outputs to **separate mixer inputs** and normally raise only the main. If the main stops, switch to the backup on the mixer

What you need

- Two Macs (**the same model is recommended** so the screens look alike)
- The same network (**wired LAN recommended**)
- CacaoSoundCues Pro on both

The delay over LAN is 1 to a few milliseconds. Raising both at once muddies the sound, so raise only one on the mixer.

Backup: connecting

1. **Main Mac**: **Backup** in the top bar → **Main Mac**. A 4-digit **pair key** appears
2. **Backup Mac**: **Backup Mac** → click **Connect** next to the main Mac found (or **connect by IP address**). For a new partner, also enter the **pair key**
3. When connected, the dot turns **green** and the latency (ms) is shown



Paired Macs are remembered, so the pair key is not needed next time.

Backup: matching the cue sheets

- On connecting, the two cue sheets are **compared**
- If they differ: **save** on the main Mac, then **Send Cue Sheet to Backup** (or **Get Cue Sheet from Main** on the backup)
- Audio files and the script are sent too, and the backup opens it automatically

> While there are unsaved changes, they show as different. Before the show, save on the main Mac, send, and check that it says **Cue sheets match**.

Received cue sheets are placed in the backup Mac's Application Support › CacaoSoundCuesPro › FromMain.

Backup: the show and taking over

- The backup Mac shows a **blue bar** at the top (following the main Mac)
- **Controls on the backup Mac are disabled** (master volume and Esc still work)
- If the connection is **lost** (no signal for 2 seconds), a **red bar** appears on the backup. Sounds keep playing
- **Take Over (operate on this Mac)** makes the backup the main Mac
- Restart the old main Mac and it becomes the **backup** and follows (roles swap)





The red bar when disconnected or not connected (Take Over on the right)

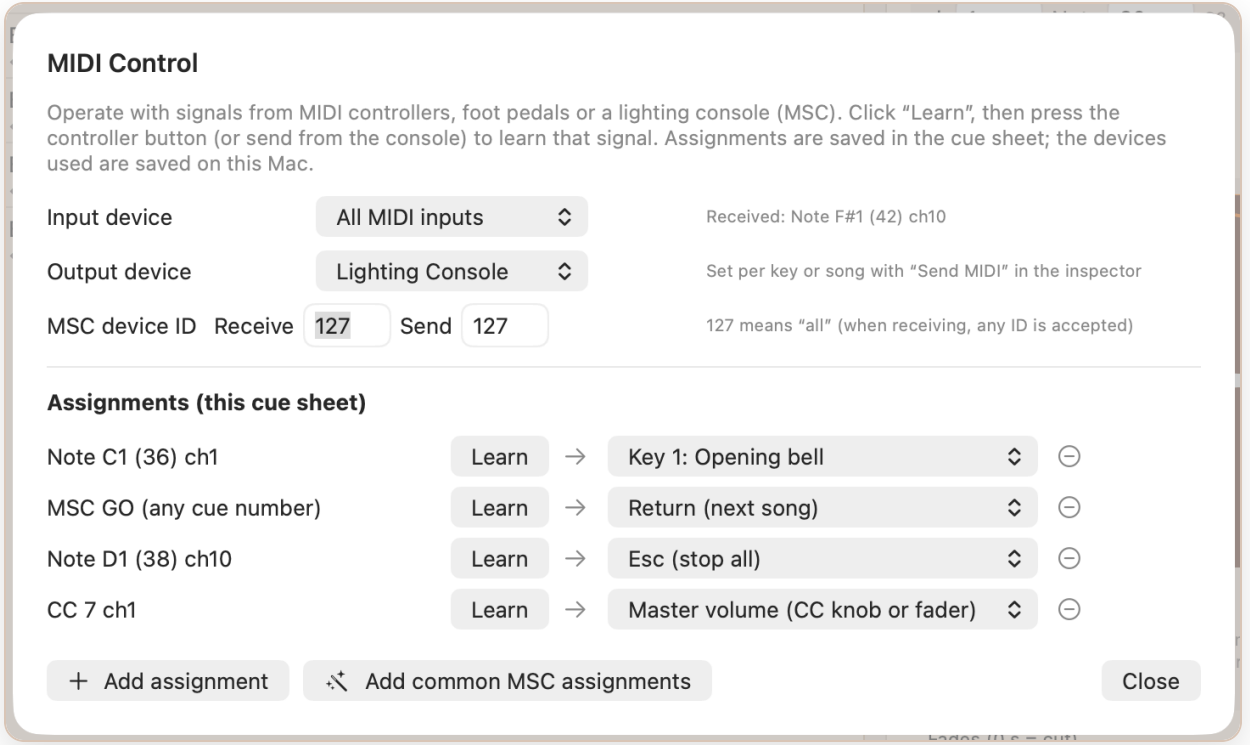
11. MIDI control

What it does

- **Receive**: operate with MIDI controllers, pads and foot pedals (notes, CC, program changes) or **MSC** from a lighting console
- **Send**: when a key or list track **starts playing**, send MIDI to a lighting console (keep sound and light cues together)

Choosing devices

1. Click **MIDI** in the top bar
2. **Input device** (usually “All MIDI inputs”)
3. **Output device**



MIDI: operating with signals

1. Click **Add assignment**
2. Click **Learn**, then press the controller button (or send from the console). The signal is filled in
3. On the right, choose **what to do**: a key, start/stop a list, **Return** (next song), **Space** (end current song), **Esc** (stop all), ↑ ↓ (Standby), script pages, or **master volume**

“Received” shows the last signal that arrived — handy for checking the connection.

USB MIDI devices appear as soon as they are plugged in. Network MIDI and the IAC driver (other apps on the same Mac) are set up in Audio MIDI Setup.

- A key can also be assigned with **Learn** under “Play by MIDI” in the inspector
- **Master volume** follows a CC knob or fader (0–127 maps to –40 to +6 dB)
- When a CC is used as a button, it counts as pressed when the value rises past 64
- Assignments are **saved in the cue sheet**, so each show can have its own

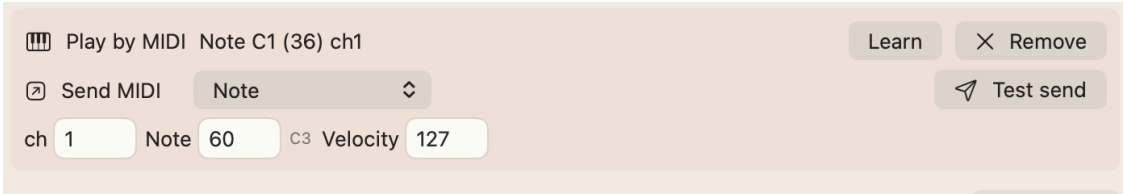
MIDI: lighting consoles (MSC)

Receiving from the console

- **Add common MSC assignments** adds GO → Return, STOP → Space, ALL OFF → Esc
- You can also assign by cue number (GO cue 12 → key A, etc.). Without a numbered assignment, the “any cue number” one is used
- **MSC device ID**: match the console’s target ID (127 accepts any)

Sending to the console

Select a key or track and, under **Send MIDI** in the inspector, choose a note, CC, program change or MSC GO (cue number). **Test send** checks it.



Nothing is sent when pressing again stops the sound. A backup Mac does not send (it does after taking over).

12. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
Cue point “Not found”	The line was removed from the script. Link it again
The script text is small	A line does not fit. Widen the panel or adjust widths
A PDF script is small or unreadable	Widen the panel (text size is fixed). Locked PDFs cannot be read
No sound from a chosen device	See the Outputs window. Is the device connected and usable?
The backup Mac cannot be found	Same network? Local network permission? Connect by IP address
The backup plays different sounds	Do the cue sheets match (Backup window)? Send again from the main Mac
The backup Mac cannot be operated	That is by design. Use Take Over to operate it
MIDI signals do nothing	Does “Received” in the MIDI window show them? If not, check the input device and cables; if so, check the assignment (for MSC, the device ID)